Cornell Brooks Public Policy
Tech Policy Institute

Polar Frontlines

Full Report

1. Executive Summary

Arctic security incidents are increasingly difficult to attribute in real time, with subsea cables severed without stated intent, unmanned platforms operating under civilian research permits, and drone activity in sensitive areas that cannot be linked to a state actor before the activity has produced its effect. This pattern presents a defenders dilemma which has no clean answer; responding forcefully to an unattributed incident generates the appearance of overreaction that adversaries can then use to claim defender aggression or spin as incursion vulnerability, while responding cautiously cedes ground and over time normalizes the activity. This report argues that the dilemma can be managed, though not eliminated, through specific measures defenders take before a crisis, and that NORAD and NORTHCOM should treat those measures as the highest priority for Arctic readiness over the next decade.

The argument draws on two wargames run in sequence between November 2025 and February 2026 under Homeland Defense Institute (HDI) sponsorship. *The Svalbard Consensus?* at Loughborough University in November 2025 ran a four inject Russian gray zone campaign against six teams over two days, with Russia in the room playing the adversary. The *Polar Frontlines* exercise at Cornell University in February 2026 took the patterns Svalbard surfaced, turned them into four testable hypotheses, and ran them through a three inject Arctic infrastructure attack against four teams playing Denmark, Greenland, Iceland, and the United States, with the adversary designed into the scenario rather than played by a team. Three of the four hypotheses received at least partial support. The fourth, which proposed that non-state actors would accelerate alliance fracture, was not confirmed, producing a useful negative result the report addresses in its own right.

Three findings carry high analytical confidence across both exercises and should anchor planning:

The first is that an ambiguous incident, which adversaries can construct using deniable platforms, civilian cover, and gradual effects, prevents defenders from cleanly classifying the event as a military matter and therefore from invoking military authority that holds the means of response, while leaving the event under the civilian authority that has jurisdiction but no means to act against what is in fact a hostile probe. Both exercises produced this pattern repeatedly, with the specific incidents in each case showing how the ambiguity was constructed and what it cost. In *Polar Frontlines,* an underwater unmanned vehicle (UUV) held a valid research permit, a tanker was AIS-dark for ninety minutes, and a swarm of unmanned aerial vehicles (UAV) were unarmed (no kinetic effects), none of which forced a military classification even when the cumulative effect of all three led to a successful incursion without response. In *Svalbard* a Russian transport landing, EISCAT photography, and cable degradation were each

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individually defensible under non-military framings, which is what allowed Russia to extract value across four phases without crossing any threshold that would have justified a collective response. The result is that defenders treat the situation as a coordination problem or infrastructure incident rather than as an attack in progress, which compounds the routing failure by making it harder to upgrade the classification later when more information becomes available.

The second is that the United States arrives at Arctic crises with a default posture that fits a different kind of adversary. When Russia is playing the gray zone, US discretion like holding intelligence and declining public attribution reads to other actors as absence of support, and US assertion like taking the lead and projecting authority reads to other actors as overreach into their sovereign space. In Svalbard, the US held back from publicly attributing Russian activity, which left Norway unable to read subsequent US silence on the policy response as restraint rather than as a failure to recognize what was happening. In Polar Frontlines, the US asserted itself in coordination decisions before the threat had been collectively named, which left Denmark unable to read US assertion as a proportionate response to a hybrid attack rather than as imposition on Greenlandic and Danish territory. The mismatch is between US default posture and the kind of adversary the geopolitical climate in the Arctic is producing, which means better communications training might not resolve it.

The third is that intelligence sharing among allies fragments under ambiguous conditions because each actor's specific reasons to limit disclosure such as source protection, relational calculation, and institutional defaults intensify rather than weaken as the threat picture stays unclear, and because no actor can see the others' disclosure decisions in real time to weigh the cost. In *Polar Frontlines* the United States held the only complete underwater vehicle information to preserve leverage, Denmark held its prior warning intelligence on trust preservation grounds, and Iceland never opened a direct bilateral channel to Greenland that would have changed the alliance picture in Inject 3. Each decision was individually defensible against the incentives the actor saw at the time. The combined effect was that no actor held a sufficient picture of the situation to justify decisive action, which is exactly what the adversary was working to produce. *Svalbard* produced the same outcome through the ISR attribution dispute, where US refusal to confirm or deny was discretion at the bilateral level but a vacuum at the alliance level.

The report develops these findings into a 2x2 scenario matrix that maps four plausible Arctic futures over the next five to ten years, with threat ambiguity on one axis and defender pre-positioning on the other. Only one of the four futures is policy acceptable. The default trajectory, absent coherent action, is the future in which defenders continue to absorb deniable probes one at a time while sovereign assertiveness declines and alliance posture frays under repeated tests of attribution discipline.

2. Background and Purpose

The two wargames at the heart of this report were run as a sequence, with each wargame designed to build on what the prior produced. Both exercises were jointly led by the Cornell Tech Policy Institute

(TPI), which allowed methodological continuity between the two and permitted findings to travel across them with reasonable confidence.

The first exercise, *The Svalbard Consensus?*, included six teams operating at different structural levels: Norway, the Svalbard Governor's Office (SGO), Russia, the United States, NATO Joint Expeditionary Force (JEF), and Greenpeace. It was structured around the 1920 Svalbard Treaty, which produced a bind in which every defensive move Norway made generated a plausible treaty violation claim from Russia. Its four injects tested how Norway and its allies would respond when the adversary had patience and legal literacy as its primary weapons, with the adversary in the room as a played team rather than scripted into the scenario. The exercise produced four findings that the project team treated as the inputs to the next exercise, namely treaty framework as primary vulnerability, information environment as dominant escalation mechanism, ISR attribution gap without protocol, and US-ally divergence on crisis communications posture.

The second exercise, *Polar Frontlines*, formalized those four findings as testable hypotheses and ran them in a new wargame. This exercise was structured around the Denmark-Greenland constitutional arrangement and the 1951 US-Denmark Defense Agreement, with the adversary designed into the scenario rather than played by a team so that the exercise could isolate alliance coordination dynamics from adversary pressure during play. *The four hypotheses, derived from The Svalbard Consensus?, tested whether attribution ambiguity fractures alliances (H1), whether hybrid campaigns exploit the military and civilian gap (H2), whether institutional roles produce non-cooperation (H3), and whether non-state actors accelerate fracture (H4). H1 was partially confirmed, H2 was confirmed, H3 was partially confirmed, and H4 was not confirmed.*

3. The Wargames

3.1 The Svalbard Stress Test

The central design choice at the core of *The Svalbard Consensus?* was to place the adversary in the room as a played team rather than scripting Russian actions into the inject narrative, which meant defender responses had to contend with adversary pressure and adaptation during play rather than with a fixed scenario script. The active adversary made *Svalbard* a stress test of how defenders behave under sustained gray zone pressure rather than a test of how defenders interpret ambiguous signals from a static scenario, which is what the subsequent exercise was designed to do.

The structural premise of *Svalbard* is the bind the 1920 Treaty places on Norway. The treaty grants Norway sovereignty over Svalbard but requires non-discriminatory access for the citizens and corporations of all signatory states, which means Russian commercial, scientific, and residential presence on the archipelago is protected and any Norwegian action that limits that presence can be framed by Russia as a treaty violation. The exercise design exploits this bind across all four injects, with each inject

constructed to produce a situation in which any defensive Norwegian response generates a plausible Russian treaty violation claim while any concession cedes ground:

Inject 1. Introduced a Russian military transport carrying 41 uniformed soldiers that declared a weather emergency and requested landing clearance at Longyear Airport, forcing Norway under international aviation law to grant access despite the Svalbard Treaty's demilitarization clause. This placed Norway in the position it would occupy for most of the exercise, legally compelled to take an action that handed Russia an exploitable opening.

Inject 2. Introduced a group of Chinese tourists stranded by the storm who photographed themselves near the EISCAT radar installation during a guided excursion and posted the images online. Within hours, social media speculation about their presence had spread widely enough that parliamentary inquiries were initiated before any team had agreed on a response.

Inject 3. Introduced a sharp bandwidth degradation on one subsea cable connecting Svalbard to mainland Norway, set against prior Russian trawler activity along the route and unidentified drones near satellite ground stations. Mutual ISR accusations then escalated the incident to a peak, with Russia citing demilitarization violations, the US declining to confirm or deny, and Norway unable to take a coherent public position.

Inject 4. Introduced a Russian naval submarine reporting propulsion failure southwest of Svalbard and formally requesting emergency docking in territorial waters under humanitarian maritime law. The White Cell adjudicated the propulsion issue as genuine but manageable, meaning the emergency was real but instrumentalized as a strategic probe.

The cumulative cost of Russian treaty exploitation across the four injects exceeded the cost of any single incident, which pointed toward a research question for the next exercise. If Russia could systematically exploit the Svalbard Treaty without crossing any threshold that justifies collective response, what does the same pattern look like under a different structural arrangement, and what hypotheses about defender behavior under ambiguous attribution can be tested formally?

3.2 The Polar Frontlines Exercise

The *Polar Frontlines* exercise was built around the structural problem created by the Denmark-Greenland constitutional arrangement combined with the 1951 US-Denmark Defense Agreement. The exercise's design choices differed from Svalbard in three big ways. First, the adversary was designed into the scenario rather than played by a team, which meant defender behavior could be observed without the contaminating effect of adversary pressure during play and which allowed the exercise to test specific hypotheses about alliance coordination under ambiguous conditions. Second, the inject sequence was structured around hybrid attacks on civilian infrastructure rather than around treaty-protected activity, which placed the central pressure on the civilian-military authority tension within the Danish-Greenlandic alliance and on the legal architecture of sovereignty. Third, the exercise packets gave

each team three decision paths per inject (labeled A, B, and C) with predetermined consequences attached to each, which allowed the exercise to measure choices systematically rather than rely entirely on facilitator interpretation.

The four state teams were Denmark, Greenland, Iceland, and the United States, with each playing its state's defense and foreign policy decision-making during the scenario and each entering the exercise with a different combination of authority and capability that shaped how the team responded to the injects. Denmark held formal defense authority over Greenland but was constrained by the constitutional arrangement that gives Greenland's Naalakkersuisut authority over domestic civilian matters, which meant any Danish military response required either Greenlandic concurrence or the invocation of higher level authority that the constitutional architecture made politically costly.

Greenland held jurisdiction over civilian emergency response across its own territory but lacked military response tools of its own, which meant Greenlandic decisions could shape the framing of incidents without resolving them. Iceland held NATO obligations and proximity to the operational area but no defense forces of its own, which meant Iceland's contribution to any response was diplomatic and informational rather than kinetic. The United States held operational control over Pituffik Space Base under the 1951 Defense Agreement but required Danish coordination for activity outside the base perimeter, which meant any US action beyond Pituffik depended on Danish consent and on the relationship between US and Danish authorities at the moment of decision. A separate non-state team called Nuna Nunatta represented a Greenlandic separatist group conducting independent information operations during the scenario, and was included specifically to test the H4 hypothesis on non-state actor influence.

Hybrid attacks on civilian infrastructure like subsea cables, satellite uplinks, communications networks, and port facilities route the immediate operational response to Greenlandic civilian authority, which holds jurisdiction but lacks military response tools, while preventing the timely activation of Danish military authority, which holds the tools but does not have the immediate operational lead.

The three injects developed the hybrid scenario through escalating ambiguity and infrastructure pressure:

Inject 1. Introduced a subsea cable cut at D-0, with Greenland Connect severed in both the Davis and Denmark Straits and the AIS-dark tanker MV Asel nearby. Cause is unknown and Greenland's commercial internet is severely degraded.

Inject 2. Introduced a UUV surfacing 12nm off Nuuk at D+2, launching a swarm of 30 to 50 UAVs tracked northeast toward Nuuk's civilian infrastructure. The vehicle matches a permitted seabed research platform, and a second UUV sits undetected in the Denmark Strait.

Inject 3. Introduced a UAV swarm dispersing across Greenland and loitering over satellite downlink dishes at D+3, collapsing connectivity. Simultaneously a second UUV moves toward Iceland's southwestern coast, reaching range within 18 to 24 hours.

The hypothesis results came in mixed. H1 was partially confirmed when ambiguity prevented full alliance mobilization but produced bloc formation rather than alliance collapse, with Denmark and the United States operating in separate decision spaces throughout. H2 was confirmed when civilian framing consistently delayed and constrained military options across all three injects, with the threshold for military response never crossed in any inject. H3 was partially confirmed when role constraints produced measurable non-cooperation, particularly between the United States and Denmark and between Iceland and the rest of the alliance in Inject 3. H4 was not confirmed when the *Nuna Nunatta* broadcast produced zero measurable effect on team decisions.

4. What the Wargames Showed

Three findings emerged from a cross-exercise comparison conducted along eight analytical dimensions, with the Polar Frontlines hypothesis results providing the formal test of patterns Svalbard had first surfaced. The dimensions and their cross-exercise comparison are summarized in the table that follows, with the developmental analysis explored in detail during the rest of the section.

SCENARIO SETUP	FRICTION	RESPONSE	OUTPUT
Structural constraint Legal limits on action	Escalation mechanism What heats things up	US-actor dynamic How allies read US intent	Key gap identified What the exercise reveals
Adversary role How the adversary plays	Information withholding How intel fragments	Alliance response How allies converge or split	
Non-state actor effect Group political narratives			

The first finding, that an ambiguous incident prevents defenders from cleanly classifying the event as a military matter and therefore from invoking the military authority that holds the response tools, draws empirical support from both exercises and from the Polar Frontlines hypothesis tests for H1 and H2. In Svalbard, the four injects repeatedly produced situations in which Norway could not formally classify Russian activity as military aggression despite its operational character, with the EISCAT photography routed to civilian aviation framing, the cable degradation routed to civilian infrastructure response, the ISR accusation dispute routed to diplomatic channels, and the submarine docking routed to maritime regulation. In Polar Frontlines, H1 (attribution ambiguity fractures the alliance) was partially confirmed when ambiguity prevented full alliance mobilization but produced bloc formation rather than collapse, and H2 (hybrid campaign exploits the military and civilian gap) was confirmed when civilian framing consistently delayed and constrained military options across all three injects. The convergence is that defenders in both exercises did not perceive the scenarios as the kind of event requiring military classification in the first place, which the report names as threat misclassification and which compounds

the authority routing failure by extending the window during which the wrong authority chain is handling the response.

The second finding is that other actors, ally and adversary alike, in both exercises read US behavior as producing friction in both directions, with US discretion read as absence of support and US assertion read as overreach into sovereign space. Norway read US silence in Svalbard as abandonment, with after-action notes recording that Norway had expected at minimum a private back-channel confirmation on contested intelligence claims and that US declination created a vacuum Russia filled. Denmark read US assertion in Polar Frontlines as domineering, with the assessment noting that the concealed P-8 sensor drop was the origin of Denmark's distrust of US transparency throughout the exercise. Whether or not the US actually approaches primary actors this way in operations, the consistency of the reading across two different exercises and two different primary actors suggests the perception is a pattern of the US-primary actor relationship under crisis conditions rather than a situational artifact of either case, though the two-case basis means the claim is provisional and should be treated as a working hypothesis until further exercises either reproduce or qualify it.

The third finding, that intelligence sharing among allies fragments under ambiguous conditions because each actor's specific reasons to limit disclosure intensify as the threat picture stays unclear, draws empirical support across both exercises. In Polar Frontlines the United States held the only complete underwater vehicle track on strategic grounds, Denmark held its prior warning intelligence on trust-preservation grounds, and Iceland never opened the I1-A bilateral channel to Greenland on institutional grounds. Each decision was individually defensible against the incentives the actor saw at the time, and the combined effect was that no actor held a sufficient picture of the situation to justify decisive action. Svalbard produced the same dynamic through the ISR attribution dispute, where US declination to confirm or deny was discretion at the bilateral level but created an information vacuum at the alliance level.

One *Polar Frontlines* hypothesis was not confirmed. H4 proposed that non-state actors would accelerate alliance fracture, with the *Nuna Nunatta* team deploying a targeted FM broadcast during Inject 2 to test whether disinformation from a Greenlandic non-state political group could destabilize coordination. The broadcast produced zero measurable effect across all four teams, with every team either disbelieving the source or declining to be seen acting on it. The assessment treats this as either a scenario design issue or a genuine finding about crisis conditions suppressing non-state influence. Either interpretation is consistent with the cross-exercise pattern that defenders process scenarios through institutional and military frames rather than through information-environment frames once a crisis has started, which means non-state actors who succeed pre-crisis at shifting public sentiment may have little additional effect once the institutional response is underway. The report treats H4 as analytically informative rather than as a failed hypothesis, since the null result narrows the picture by ruling out one mechanism of alliance fracture.

The cross-exercise picture supports the three findings with high analytical confidence, since each finding receives support from independent exercise designs (Svalbard's in-room adversary, Polar Frontlines'

designed-in adversary) and from both qualitative play records and the formal hypothesis tests in Polar Frontlines. What the picture establishes is that the three findings are not artifacts of a single exercise design or a single structural premise but recur under different structural conditions when defenders face the kind of ambiguous threats both exercises were built to produce.

5. Strategic Foresight Analysis

The findings developed above establish what defenders do under ambiguous Arctic threat conditions, but they don't tell us what to do about it. Strategic foresight builds plausible future states by identifying the variables most likely to drive outcomes and tracing how those variables interact over time. The two variables that emerged from the cross exercise analysis as most important to Arctic outcomes are threat ambiguity and defender pre-positioning, both of which can plausibly take high or low values over the next five to ten years and which together produce four distinct futures with different cost structures and different decision points.

Threat ambiguity describes the degree to which an adversary can keep an incident from being attributed clearly enough to trigger a defensive response, through deniable platforms, civilian cover, or gradual effects that keep events below the threshold of confident identification. The variable matters because a clear attack permits a proportionate response while an ambiguous one forces defenders to choose between responding without evidence, which risks the appearance of overreach, or withholding response, which risks normalizing the activity. Both exercises supported it as the defining variable by showing what defenders do when it operates against them, with the Russia team in Svalbard exploiting treaty-protected presence and the Polar Frontlines inject sequence producing cumulative damage through legally permitted platforms. The future state of this variable is largely outside defender control, since any shift depends on adversary calculus about whether overt operations would produce returns exceeding what ambiguity delivers.

Defender pre-positioning describes how much structural readiness defenders have in place before a crisis begins, including authority routing for civilian-coded incidents, intelligence-sharing infrastructure, and exercise-iterated bilateral relationships that operate without requiring negotiation in the moment. The variable matters because pre-positioning is a major Arctic readiness factor that defenders themselves control. Both exercises supported it as a defining variable by showing the cost of its absence, with Norway and the United States entering Svalbard without an ISR attribution protocol and the absence of pre-agreed authority routing between Denmark and Greenland in Polar Frontlines producing delays at every inject. The future state of this variable is largely under defender control, with the plausible range running from continued ad hoc response to comprehensive pre-positioning across the three measures.

The resulting scenario matrix produces four plausible Arctic futures, of which only one is policy acceptable. Using the example of an unidentified drone near a Greenlandic airport and critical

infrastructure, drawn from the full spectrum drone warfare (FSDW) scenarios in the wargame, we can see how each future plays out differently across the four cells.

	Low Threat Ambiguity	**High Threat Ambiguity**
Low Defender Pre-Positioning	Scenario 1: Reactive Success at a Cost	Scenario 2: Slow Erosion
High Defender Pre-Positioning	Scenario 3: Deterrent Holds	Scenario 4: Protects the Line

Scenario 1: Reactive Success at a Cost, where threat ambiguity is low and defender pre-positioning is low, is the case where overt threats meet unprepared defenders. Adversaries operate openly, but defenders lack the recognition frameworks, authority routing, and intelligence-sharing infrastructure to respond coherently. The drone is recovered and clearly attributed, but Greenlandic civilian authorities handle the immediate response before the defense dimension is recognized, Denmark wades in late while US coordination takes thirty-six hours, public messaging emerges from Nuuk, Copenhagen, and Washington at different times with different framings, and adversary information operations exploit the gap to claim defender disarray even as the response succeeds. The incident resolves but trust damage carries into the next phase, usually a return to high threat ambiguity where defenders now have reduced public trust and the same pre-positioning gaps.

Scenario 2: Slow Erosion, where threat ambiguity is high and defender pre-positioning is low, is the default trajectory. Adversaries keep probing in the gray zone, and defenders process each incident as a one-off rather than recognizing the pattern. The same drone appears under the same ambiguous conditions, shutting down operations and spreading panic, but Greenlandic civilian authorities treat it as an airspace anomaly, Danish defense is not brought in, Nuuk and Copenhagen put out fragmented public messaging, and the case is closed when the drone leaves. The next drone arrives some months later and receives the same treatment, with no one connecting the dots into a pattern that would warrant a strategic response. Over time coalition confidence degrades, adversary presence expands past easy reversal, Greenlandic independence pressure intensifies, and outside actors find openings to trade infrastructure for political access. No single event registers as a threat at all, which is exactly what the ambiguity strategy is built to produce.

Scenario 3: Deterrent Holds, where threat ambiguity is low and defender pre-positioning is high, is the case where overt threats meet prepared defenders. Adversaries operate openly, but the same recognition frameworks and protocols that handle ambiguous threats handle clear ones as well. The drone is recovered and clearly attributed to a state actor, and pre-arranged authority puts Danish defense in the lead within hours, with fast public attribution and coordinated messaging across Nuuk, Copenhagen, and allied capitals. The adversary absorbs costs that exceed expected returns and either continues at higher cost or shifts back to ambiguous methods where pre-positioning now constrains them, making Deterrent Holds a transitional state rather than an end point.

Scenario 4: Protects the Line, where threat ambiguity is high and defender pre-positioning is high, is the policy goal. Adversaries keep probing in the gray zone, but defenders are ready and recognize the probes for what they are. A small drone of unknown origin appears near a Greenlandic airport and critical infrastructure, forcing temporary shutdowns and triggering local panic, and Greenlandic and Danish authorities recognize the incident as a probe rather than an isolated airspace anomaly, activating pre-agreed authority routing within ninety minutes and putting out a coordinated joint statement that frames the incident publicly before adversary information operations can shape the narrative. The drone eventually leaves without attribution, but the public response stays coherent and the incident is logged into a pattern that pre-positioning is built to track.

6. Cross-Exercise Lessons Learned

The cross-exercise comparison produces three categories of lesson for senior planners:

The first lesson is about generalizability. *Svalbard* ran on treaty exploitation with the adversary in the room, and *Polar Frontlines* ran on constitutional arrangement with the adversary written into the scenario, with the two exercises differing in structural premise, adversary representation, team composition, and inject design, but producing the same patterns across all three findings. The reproduction of those patterns under different structural conditions is what allows the findings to be treated as reliable inputs to planning rather than as artifacts of how either exercise happened to be constructed, which is the methodological warrant the sequenced design was meant to produce.

The second lesson is about implementation. The work that follows from the findings is bilateral and multilateral working coordination rather than budget work, since none of the measures it produces requires new force structure or new acquisition cycles, while all of them require coordination time, political will, and exercise iteration, which means the main constraint is political and institutional rather than fiscal. The work also has to be done with each primary actor independently rather than through a single multilateral framework, since the relationship between the United States and each Arctic primary actor is shaped by different agreements, different histories, and different domestic politics, and a single framework would obscure precisely the differences that the measures are designed to address.

The third lesson is specific to professional military education and emerges from the comparison between the *Polar Frontlines* official run with practitioners and the Cornell graduate-level run with the same scenario and action card system. Students escalated more than practitioners across most teams, with the Iceland team as the exception where students struggled to inhabit the constrained no-military role, and the pattern points in two directions that both bear on PME design. Students may be reading the threat picture more accurately than practitioners, since the practitioner default toward coordination framing looks like something professional experience produces rather than something defenders read off the scenario, but students also escalate without fully recognizing the costs of escalation in alliance and political terms, which means cadet training at USAFA needs to address both tendencies through

facilitator notes that distinguish accurate threat reading from appropriate response calibration (see accompanying handbook).

7. Policy Measures for Planning and PME Use

Three pre-positioning measures emerge from the wargame work. Each addresses one of the three findings and each closes a specific gap between current defender behavior and the Holds the Line scenario described above. All three are grounded in institutional and legal architecture specific to the region of the Arctic under analysis, rather than in generic alliance management.

1. Coordination protocols for ambiguous hybrid attacks on Arctic civilian infrastructure currently do not exist in pre-positioned form, since the existing emergency response architectures in each Arctic state handle unambiguous emergencies but offer no protocol when classification itself is contested. The first measure fills the gap by agreeing in advance, for each of the four incident types both exercises surfaced (infrastructure anomaly, dual-use platform under civilian framing, aerial threat under civilian framing, and vessel distress in sovereign waters), the triggers for treating an incident as potentially hostile, the conditions under which military authority activates as a joint decision between civilian and military authorities, and the messaging templates and private attribution channels that let public framing move within the first ninety minutes rather than be negotiated under crisis pressure. NORAD and NORTHCOM can drive the US contribution through bilateral defense engagement and the Arctic Security Forces Roundtable, and the measure is feasible because it adapts existing architecture rather than building new structures.

2. The friction the second finding identifies between US discretion and primary actor expectations persists despite extensive existing US-Arctic exercise practice, since current bilateral and multilateral programs iterate conventional warfare, cold weather operations, and force projection rather than the ambiguous hybrid scenarios where the friction actually manifests. The second measure addresses this by adding standing hybrid scenario tracks to existing bilateral exercise programs, iterating Arctic scenarios at a regular cadence at the working level (DOD-MOD, Combatant Command equivalents through NORAD and NORTHCOM, and embassy political-military sections), drawing on the Polar Frontlines methodology, and producing advisory output rather than binding commitments. The tracks do not eliminate the underlying structural asymmetry, but they reduce the surprise component that makes the friction costly when an incident arrives, and the addition is incremental to existing exercise infrastructure rather than a new program.

3. Existing Arctic intelligence cooperation surfaces threat picture through forums like the Arctic Security Forces Roundtable, but produces no periodic joint analytic product focused on gray

zone activity, which leaves each primary actor reading the threat picture through its own assessment and weakens the shared baseline that would offset the fragmentation the third finding identifies. The third measure addresses this through a recurring joint Arctic gray zone threat assessment cycle, drawing analytic contributions from primary actor defense intelligence services at unclassified and low classification levels and producing a synthesized product that catalogs activity patterns, attribution indicators, and emerging incident types across the region. The cycle extends to Arctic gray zone activity the bilateral threat assessment model NORAD already runs for North American homeland defense, with NORTHCOM positioned to drive development in coordination with the Arctic Security Forces Roundtable, and the measure is feasible because the analytic substrate already exists in each contributing service, which leaves the work as synthesis rather than new collection.

The three measures together constitute the pre-positioning posture that moves Arctic defenders from the Slow Erosion default trajectory toward the Holds the Line scenario, with implementation cost primarily in bilateral and multilateral time at the working level rather than in budget, which means the main constraint is political and institutional rather than fiscal. The handbook accompanying this report adapts the Polar Frontlines packets for use at USAFA, with facilitator notes that exercise these three measures specifically and surface the gaps that materialize when one or more measure is absent.

8. Conclusion and Next Steps

The two wargames in this research program produced findings substantial enough to act on, but they did not close every question that bears on Arctic readiness. Several gaps remain that would warrant attention in subsequent exercises. The first is adversary command and control dynamics under sustained pressure, since both exercises observed adversary behavior over compressed time horizons rather than across the multi-year campaigns Arctic strategy actually contemplates. The second is the China factor, which neither exercise modeled directly but which is likely to become significant. The third is climate driven infrastructure stress, where the interaction between hybrid attacks and infrastructure already strained by Arctic environmental change is interesting to study. The fourth is simultaneous escalation across multiple Arctic theaters, since both exercises treated their geographic regions in relative isolation while real Arctic crises are likely to develop across coordinated fronts.

The recommended next exercise is an adapted *Polar Frontlines* run at USAFA with cadets, using the handbook accompanying this report as the operational kit. The handbook reproduces the team packets, the inject sequence, and the action card system in forms appropriate for PME use, with facilitator notes that draw on the student-run comparison findings. Running the exercise at USAFA produces three outputs at once. First, it generates the next data point for the research program by testing whether the patterns this report documents reproduce in a different participant cohort. Second, it develops cadet familiarity with the structural conditions of Arctic crisis response before those cadets become the operators responsible for managing such conditions. Third, it provides the institutional bridge between the wargaming research and the planning work the three pre-positioning measures require.

The pattern across the report is that Arctic ambiguous threat readiness is achievable through coordination rather than capital, but only if defenders commit to the structural work before the next ambiguous incident forces it under crisis pressure.

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Polar Frontlines

Cadet Handbook

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ABOUT THIS EXERCISE

Polar Frontlines is an educational wargame developed at Cornell University as part of Homeland Defense Institute (HDI) supported integrated wargaming research on full spectrum drone threats to Arctic critical infrastructure, and adapted here for PME and cadet use. It models a 72-hour gray zone crisis in which the rules of escalation are ambiguous, attribution is uncertain, and the institutions designed to manage interstate conflict do not fully fit the threat. Four teams, Denmark, Greenland, Iceland, and the United States, work through three injects, a subsea cable cut, an underwater vehicle launching a drone swarm, and drones blocking satellite downlink, each designed to surface the kinds of decision failures the current Arctic defense architecture is not built to handle.

The exercise supports NORAD and NORTHCOM work on Arctic homeland defense against full spectrum drone threats by giving cadets direct exposure to three dynamics that the wargames have surfaced as central, namely how to recognize hybrid attacks on civilian infrastructure when classification itself is contested, how to manage friction between the United States and Arctic primary actors when a crisis arrives faster than relationships can adjust, and how to build a shared threat picture across actors whose intelligence services have different sources, clearance architectures, and reasons to limit disclosure. The exercise does not have a single right answer. It is designed to reveal what current institutional defaults cannot do under ambiguous conditions, so that cadets graduate having seen those gaps once before they encounter them in operations.

USING THIS HANDBOOK

This handbook contains everything needed to run the exercise. The Facilitator Packet that follows sets the scene, lists the injects, and identifies the structural tensions the exercise is built to surface. The four country packets give each team its starting intelligence, decision options, and constraints. The Red Cell packet for Nuna Nunatta is for the player or instructor running the Greenlandic independence movement that broadcasts into the room during the crisis.

Before the Exercise

If you are a cadet participating, read only your country's packet in advance, including the historical and institutional context that frames your team's position. Reading other teams' materials defeats the purpose of the exercise, which is to see how decisions look from inside one role under limited information. If you are running the exercise as a facilitator, read all materials in advance, with particular attention to the inject timing and the action card mechanics that gate what unlocks when.

During the Exercise

Each inject runs for a set deliberation window. Use the time to work through the situation within your team, decide on a course of action, and prepare what you will say to the room. Action cards trigger when your team chooses specific options, and they unlock new information or open new channels with other teams, so pay attention to what the facilitator hands you mid-inject since these are the operationally significant moments. At the end of each inject, complete the self-assessment scoring table in your

country’s packet and record your team’s decisions in the notes field before the next inject begins. The Red Cell broadcasts at moments of its choosing. You cannot stop the broadcast. You can respond, ignore, or contradict it.

FACILITATOR PACKET

Exercise Use Only

FOUR PLAYERS: Denmark | Greenland | Iceland | United States

THREE INJECTS: I1: Subsea Cable Cut | I2: UUV Launches UAV Swarm | I3: UAVs Block Downlink

QUICK REFERENCE

Hypotheses Being Tested

H1 — Attribution ambiguity fractures the alliance. Watch For: Do players fragment when no one can agree on who did this?

H2 — Hybrid campaign exploits the military/civilian gap. Watch For: Does the civilian framing of threats prevent military response?

H3 — Institutional roles produce non-cooperation. Watch For: Does role clarity (sovereign vs. autonomous vs. no military) create deadlock?

H4 — Non-state actors accelerate fracture. Watch For: Does Nuna Nunatta's messaging deepen or exploit existing cracks?

Inject Timeline

I1 — D-0 H+00 — Subsea Cable Cut. Key Facts: MV Asel dark; Greenland Connect severed Davis and Denmark Straits. Hypotheses: H1, H2, H3.

I2 — D+2 H+48 — UUV Surfaces, UAV Swarm Launches. Key Facts: UUV surfaces 12nm off Nuuk; 30-50 UAVs launch toward civilian infra. Hypotheses: H1, H2, H3, H4.

I3 — D+3 H+72 — UAVs Block Downlink. Key Facts: UAVs park over satellite dishes; second UUV approaches Iceland. Hypotheses: All four.

Key Structural Tensions

Denmark and Greenland

Denmark holds defence authority; Greenland holds emergency management. Denmark has undisclosed prior warning intel across all three injects. Greenland cannot invoke NATO; must go through Denmark. Rigsombudsmanden is the only hardwired link between them, intact throughout.

Denmark and the United States

1951 Defense Agreement: US needs Danish coordination outside Pituffik. Both teams are briefed to be the dominant voice in any response. Their role descriptions use nearly identical language.

Attribution Gap

UUV is registered as a seabed research vessel with a valid permit (Danish intel, I2). US has the two-UUV picture; others do not unless the US shares it. No actor has a full picture without information sharing. Action cards create asymmetric intelligence based on player choices.

Iceland's Structural Position

No standing military; NATO infrastructure on soil. Iceland cannot control CRC Loki and Keflavik report automatically to NATO regardless of Iceland's choices. Iceland's I1 bilateral choice with Greenland gates the I3 relay option. Only team fully connected in I3 (FARICE-1 and DANICE intact).

Action Cards: What Unlocks What

Iceland I1-A — Trigger: Reach out to Greenland directly. Effect: Bilateral Denmark-bypass channel opens; Greenland can use it in I3-B.

Denmark I1-A — Trigger: Dispatch inspection vessel nationally. Effect: HDMS Triton picks up anomalous subsea contact (early UUV signal).

US I2-A — Trigger: Continue to hold, observe. Effect: US builds most complete UUV track; 24-36 hour surfacing window near Iceland.

Greenland I2-C — Trigger: Go public, demand international response. Effect: Civilian observer network activates; swarm staging pattern revealed.

Nuna Nunatta: Red Cell Summary

Who: Greenlandic independence movement, externally funded by an unnamed actor. Active on FM radio, which remains operational when digital communications collapse.

Role: Exploits Denmark-Greenland and Denmark-US tensions. Does not need to be accurate, only timely and plausible. Feeds H4.

Deploy: Facilitator controls all Nuna Nunatta outputs. Recommended primary window is Inject 2. FM broadcast reaches Iceland and Greenland's surviving radio network. See separate Red Cell Packet for scripts.

INJECT 1 | D-0 H+00 | SUBSEA CABLE CUT

Situation

0340 local time. Greenland Connect severed in both the Davis and Denmark Straits. MV Asel (Gabon-flagged tanker) was in the area, AIS dark for 90 minutes around the time of severance. Cause unknown. Greenland's commercial internet is severely degraded and mobile is intermittent, with some connectivity remaining through satellite re-routing. GPS unaffected.

Intelligence by Player

Denmark

Classified prior warning intelligence (fragile sourcing, wide attribution window) indicating possible hostile interest in Greenlandic infrastructure. Not yet shared with any party.

Greenland

Cable fault is visible and public. No cause confirmed. No military assets. Emergency management authority only.

Iceland

Greenland Connect terminus is in Reykjavik; Iceland has technical visibility on the fault. No unique intelligence on cause. Closest cable repair ship is currently in Reykjavik port.

United States

Pituffik tracking a subsea contact in the Davis Strait matching a seabed mapping vessel profile: slow-moving, operating at depth. Source is fragile. No allied request for the assessment has been received.

Decision Options by Player

Denmark

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Dispatch nearest inspection vessel toward the fault. Do not notify NATO. Inform Naalakkersuisut after.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Contact Naalakkersuisut through the Rigsombudsmanden before dispatching assets. Frame as coordination, not assertion.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Raise through NATO channels immediately. Submit prior warning intelligence. Accept it goes on the record.

Greenland

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Contact the cable operator directly. Issue a public statement framing this as a technical fault under investigation. Activate emergency management.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Contact Denmark through the Rigsombudsmanden. Request Denmark's assessment and ask to be consulted before any public statements are made.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Issue a public Naalakkersuisut statement asserting Greenland's right to be informed and consulted. Contact international partners directly.

Iceland

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Contact Naalakkersuisut directly as a Nordic neighbour. Offer Iceland as a communications relay. Establish a direct bilateral channel outside the Danish chain. Unlocks I3-B for Greenland.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Contact Copenhagen rather than Nuuk. Offer Iceland's connectivity and position as a resource. Work through the sovereign authority.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Treat this as a NATO-level event from the start. Route all observations and offers through alliance channels only.

United States

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Protect the source. Keep Pituffik on internal alert. Do not share the subsea contact data. Monitor and build the intelligence picture.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Contact Denmark privately and indicate the US has reason for concern about the cable event, without sharing specifics.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Push a sanitised version of the threat assessment through NATO channels. Accept the wider source exposure risk.

Hypothesis Watch Points

H1: Attribution fractures alliance

Does Denmark share prior warning or sit on it? Do players assume accident or deliberate act? Does diverging attribution prevent a coordinated response?

H2: Hybrid exploits military/civilian gap

Does civilian framing delay escalation to NATO? Does Denmark's lack of cable repair capability change the calculus?

H3: Institutional roles produce non-cooperation

Does Denmark assert defence authority without Greenland's consent? Does Greenland's emergency management framing exclude Denmark? Does Iceland act as a national actor or as NATO infrastructure?

Nuna Nunatta window (optional in I1)

Not recommended unless players are already fragmenting badly. Hold for Inject 2 for maximum effect.

Facilitator note: The two things to record coming out of I1: does Denmark inform Greenland before or after acting, and does the US share the subsea contact? Both decisions set up all subsequent dynamics.

INJECT 2 | D+2 H+48 | UUV SURFACES, UAV SWARM LAUNCHES

Situation

A UUV of unknown origin has surfaced approximately 12 nautical miles off Nuuk. Within 90 minutes it launches a swarm of 30 to 50 small UAVs tracked northeast toward Nuuk: residential areas, the hospital, power substations, the port. No attack has occurred. Intent is unknown. The Greenlandic population can see the swarm. The UUV's hull profile matches a registered seabed research platform with a valid permit to operate in the region, so its presence had been logged and appeared unremarkable.

Intelligence by Player

Denmark

Hull profile and beacon matched to registered research platform with valid permit (legally logged, unremarkable). UAV swarm tracked northeast toward Nuuk. Prior warning still undisclosed if Denmark chose A or B in I1.

Greenland

UAVs visible from the ground. Emergency services receiving calls. No military assets. Denmark has not yet made a public statement.

Iceland

Keflavik P-8s tracking the UUV; data in the NATO pipeline automatically through CRC Loki regardless of Iceland's national choices. Iceland cannot control that flow.

United States

Acoustic surveillance has been tracking a second subsea contact in the Greenland Sea for 72 hours: same acoustic signature family, same depth profile, same transit pattern as the Nuuk UUV. There were two of them. The second is now in the Denmark Strait.

Critical asymmetry: Only the US knows there are two UUVs. No other player has the second contact unless the US shares it. This is the central attribution puzzle of the exercise.

Decision Options by Player

Denmark

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Issue a measured public statement. Do not disclose the prior warning. Handle through national channels and wait for more information.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Acknowledge to NATO partners that Denmark had some prior indication without releasing specifics. Coordinate with Naalakkersuisut before any public statement.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Submit the full prior warning assessment to NATO. Accept the credibility cost. Position Denmark as leading from transparency.

Greenland

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Declare a civilian emergency. Direct population away from likely target areas. Contact Denmark via Rigsombudsmanden requesting military assessment. No attribution statements.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Formally request Denmark invoke defence authority. Reach out bilaterally to Iceland and the US. Ask Denmark to speak publicly only after coordinating with Naalakkersuisut.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Issue an immediate public statement. Contact NATO partners directly. Call for an international response. Action card triggered.

Iceland

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Let NATO pipeline data flow automatically. Do not make national statements. If the bilateral channel to Greenland is open, keep it available but do not activate it yet.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Contact Denmark and offer to help connect the picture. Offer Reykjavik as a coordination point.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Submit Iceland's national position formally to NATO. Request the alliance treat this as a collective security event.

United States

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Protect the source. Continue observing. Let the public picture develop through the media. Action card triggered if chosen.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Share the UUV contact data with Denmark and Iceland bilaterally. Accept that they may push it to NATO.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Push the full UUV contact assessment through NATO. Accept the source burn risk. Give the alliance the connecting picture it needs for attribution.

Hypothesis Watch Points

H1 and H2: Attribution and hybrid gap

Does the research vessel cover story delay military framing? Do players treat UAVs as a civilian safety issue or a military threat? Denmark has no air defence in region: does this become a friction point?

H3: Institutional non-cooperation

Does Greenland attempt to bypass Denmark to reach the US or NATO directly? Does Iceland function as NATO infrastructure or as a national actor? Does Denmark's prior warning admission change alliance dynamics?

H4: Non-state actors accelerate fracture

Prime window for Nuna Nunatta deployment. Recommended: FM broadcast during I2 deliberations. Target Greenland and Iceland teams simultaneously. Message: Denmark is concealing intelligence; Greenland should seek the US.

Facilitator watch

Track who learns about the second UUV and when. Record whether the US shares or holds in I2: this gates I3 options.

INJECT 3 | D+3 H+72 | UAVs BLOCK DOWNLINK | SECOND UUV APPROACHES ICELAND

Situation

The UAV swarm has dispersed across Greenland and positioned over satellite uplink dishes at relay stations, government buildings, the airport authority hub, and residential infrastructure. Their physical presence is blocking the downlink. Commercial satellite internet is failing across settlements. GPS is degrading. Mobile is down in most areas. The UAVs have not fired and are not visibly armed. Removing them would require shooting them down over populated areas. Simultaneously: a second UUV with a profile consistent with the Nuuk vehicle has been detected moving toward Iceland's southwestern coast. It has not surfaced. It has not launched anything. It could reach range of Icelandic coastal infrastructure within 18 to 24 hours. Iceland has no military.

Communications State

Denmark

Channels Intact: Rigsombudsmanden line to Greenland intact. Channels Degraded: Critical infrastructure monitoring largely silent. Overall: Partial.

Greenland

Channels Intact: Rigsombudsmanden to Denmark intact. FM/HF radio intact. Channels Degraded: Satellite internet failing. Mobile down. GPS degrading. Overall: FM and Rigsombudsmanden only.

Iceland

Channels Intact: FARICE-1 and DANICE fully intact. Only fully-connected player. Channels Degraded: If I1-A chosen: bilateral channel to Greenland open. Overall: Full.

United States

Channels Intact: Pituffik SATCOM fully operational. Unrestricted communications. Channels Degraded: Has most complete intelligence picture if held from I2. Overall: Full.

Decision Options by Player

Denmark

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Issue a Kingdom statement invoking constitutional authority. Speak for Greenland without waiting for Naalakkersuisut to coordinate.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Contact Naalakkersuisut through the Rigsombudsmanden before issuing any statement. Agree on shared messaging. Request Greenland's consent for military action.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Request Article 4 consultations. Submit Denmark's full intelligence picture. Lead the alliance response.

Greenland

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Broadcast on FM. Direct civilian infrastructure operators to take protective action. Report to Denmark through the Rigsombudsmanden. Let Denmark decide on military response.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. If Iceland bilateral channel exists from I1-A: relay Greenland's situation to NATO through Reykjavik, bypassing Copenhagen. Not available if Iceland chose B or C in I1.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Contact Pituffik Space Base directly. Request the US assume coordination authority for the response. This is an extraordinary step: asking a foreign military to take a role constitutionally belonging to Denmark.

Iceland

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. If bilateral channel to Greenland exists, use it to relay Greenland's situation to NATO. Log the second UUV contact nationally. Request alliance tasking through NATO channels.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Contact the US bilaterally and request a direct response to the second UUV approaching Iceland's coast. Operate outside the NATO framework for a faster bilateral commitment.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Submit a formal NATO ASW tasking request. Put Iceland's threat formally on the alliance agenda alongside Greenland's crisis. Force the alliance to address both simultaneously.

United States

A — Civilian — Stay civilian. E.g. Offer Pituffik as a joint coordination hub. Make clear the US is supporting, not leading. Defer to Denmark on decisions affecting Greenland.

B — Bilateral — Engage bilaterally. E.g. Engage Denmark directly and bilaterally. Separately commit to Iceland bilaterally on the second UUV.

C — Escalatory — Escalate. E.g. Declassify the full intelligence picture. Push everything to NATO. Accept source burn, prior warning questions, and attribution concerns all surface simultaneously.

Hypothesis Watch Points

H1: Attribution fractures alliance

Two simultaneous threats: does the alliance address them coherently? Does the full US attribution share change the room, or does it come too late?

H2: Hybrid military/civilian gap

UAVs are not armed: does civilian response logic still dominate? Can anyone actually shoot them down, and under whose authority?

H3: Institutional non-cooperation

Does Greenland bypass Denmark to reach the US directly? Does Denmark invoke authority over Greenland's objection? Does Iceland's ASW request force NATO to handle two crises at once?

H4: Non-state actors accelerate fracture

Second Nuna Nunatta window if not deployed in I2. Comms collapse means FM is now the primary channel in Greenland. A Nuna Nunatta broadcast is the only thing many Greenlanders hear in I3. Maximum effect: broadcast while Denmark and Greenland are in a Rigsombudsmanden dispute.

Facilitator note

Greenland I3-B is only available if Iceland chose I1-A. Confirm active channels at the top of the inject before options are exercised. Record pathway dependencies for the debrief: these are H3 evidence.

Scoring Dimensions

Coordination — Did players communicate across teams? Was it proactive or reactive?

Information Sharing — Was intelligence shared, withheld, or shared late? What was the cost?

Institutional Role Clarity — Did players stay within their constitutional or structural role?

Escalation Management — Were escalation choices proportionate? Did the civilian/military framing shift?

Debrief anchors: When was the first information shared across teams? What was the last thing withheld and why? Did Nuna Nunatta change any decision? Which channel proved most important, and which player was most constrained by their institutional role?

ACTION CARDS

Iceland (I1, A - Stay civilian — reach out to Greenland directly)

ACTION CARD — triggered if you chose this option. Your outreach to Greenland has been acknowledged. A direct bilateral channel between Reykjavik and Nuuk is open. This channel is available throughout Inject 2 and Inject 3. It is the only non-Danish pathway through which Greenland can communicate with the outside world if its communications collapse.

Denmark (I1, A - Stay civilian — dispatch inspection vessel, handle nationally)

ACTION CARD — triggered if you chose this option. HDMS Triton's sensors pick up an anomalous subsea contact near the cable fault — slow-moving, operating at depth, not consistent with the tanker or any known commercial vessel. The contact is not visually confirmed. This is an early, vague signal that something other than the tanker may have caused the severance.

United States (I2, A - Stay civilian: continue to hold, observe)

ACTION CARD — triggered if you chose this option. Your continuous passive observation has built the most complete track on the second subsea contact — now moving toward Iceland. Pituffik's sensors give you a precise surfacing window: approximately 24 to 36 hours from now, southwestern Iceland, consistent with the approach vector used at Nuuk. No other team has this. You can use it, share it, or hold it.

Greenland (I2, C - Escalate: go public, demand international response)

ACTION CARD — triggered if you chose this option. Your public statement activates a civilian observer network — journalists, local officials, residents — who begin feeding your government ground-level reports on UAV movement and flight patterns. The aggregated picture suggests the swarm is staging over the port and the main satellite relay station on the city's eastern edge before moving further. This is not attribution. It is a behavioural pattern only visible from the ground. You can act on it through emergency management — but military countermeasures are Denmark's domain.

DENMARK

Kingdom of Denmark & Arctic Command

How to Use This Packet

Read only the inject currently in play. At the end of each inject, complete the self-assessment scoring table before the next inject begins. Options A, B, and C are examples of what your team might do. You are required to choose one path, but not required to choose the example action. If your choice triggers an Action Card, follow those instructions exactly.

A — Civilian / Domestic B — Bilateral C — Escalatory

Your Role

You are the Kingdom of Denmark, acting through the government in Copenhagen and Arctic Command. You are the sovereign defence authority for Greenland.

Your goal is to be the dominant voice in any response, projecting power and ensuring no ally acts in this region without your lead. You hold authority here, sovereign or strategic, and you intend to exercise it visibly.

You Control

- Defence policy for Greenland
- Military asset deployment
- NATO engagement on behalf of the Kingdom
- Foreign affairs

You Do Not Control

- Greenland's internal emergency management
- Naalakkersuisut's public statements
- Commercial cable infrastructure

Assets and Capabilities

HDMS Triton and Vædderen (Thetis-class inspection vessels). HDMS Ejnar Mikkelsen (Knud Rasmussen-class OPV). F-35s at Skrydstrup which is 3,500km from Greenland, not a real-time asset. Rigsombudsmanden in Nuuk, your secure channel to Naalakkersuisut.

Key Constraint

No dedicated cable repair vessel. No air defence assets in the region. You hold prior warning intelligence that was not shared before the exercise began.

Glossary

Rigsombudsmanden — Danish High Commissioner in Nuuk. Your secure hardwired channel to Naalakkersuisut.

Arctic Command — Danish military command responsible for the Arctic region including Greenland.

Thetis-class — Danish naval patrol vessels. Capable of reaching the Davis Strait within days. Not combat warships.

NATO pipeline — The shared intelligence architecture through which alliance members receive and contribute intelligence automatically when formally engaged.

INJECT 1 · D-0 · H+00 — Subsea Cable Cut

Situation

At 0340 local time, Greenland Connect is severed in both the Davis and Denmark Straits. The cause is unknown. A Gabon-flagged tanker, MV Asel, was in the area, AIS dark for 90 minutes around the time of severance. Greenland's connectivity is severely degraded. You are the sovereign defence authority for Greenland. The territory is 3,500km away. Your nearest naval assets are HDMS Triton and Vædderen. You have no dedicated cable repair capability.

Your Intelligence

You hold classified prior warning intelligence collected weeks ago, fragile sourcing, wide attribution window. The intelligence indicated possible hostile interest in Greenlandic infrastructure. You did not share this before the incident. Naalakkersuisut has not yet formally contacted you.

Lead Question

Denmark is the sovereign defence authority for a territory 3,500km away that has just suffered a critical infrastructure failure. What does Denmark do in the first hours and does it act with or without Greenland's consent?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian: dispatch inspection vessel, handle nationally (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Dispatch the nearest inspection vessel toward the cable fault area. Do not notify NATO. Move first, inform Naalakkersuisut after.

B — Engage bilaterally: notify Greenland, coordinate asset dispatch (BILATERAL)

E.g. Contact Naalakkersuisut through the Rigsombudsmanden before dispatching assets. Frame as coordination, not assertion. Request Greenland's consent for Danish naval presence in Greenlandic waters.

C — Escalate: notify NATO, enter pipeline, assume lead (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Raise this through NATO channels immediately. Submit Denmark's prior warning intelligence. Position Denmark as leading the alliance response. Accept that your prior warning will now be on the record.

Notes:

INJECT 1 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION	0 (None)	1 (Low)	2 (Mod)	3 (High)	NOTES
Coordination	○	○	○	○	
Information Sharing	○	○	○	○	
Institutional Role Clarity	○	○	○	○	
Escalation Management	○	○	○	○	

Notes on decisions made this inject:

INJECT 2 · D+2 · H+48 — UUV Surfaces, UAV Swarm Launches

Situation

A UUV of unknown origin has surfaced off Nuuk and launched a swarm of UAVs now moving toward civilian infrastructure. No attack has occurred. Intent is unknown. The Greenlandic population can see the swarm. You have no air defence assets in the region. Your F-35s at Skrydstrup are 3,500km away, not a real-time option. Your prior warning intelligence, if not yet disclosed, is now acutely relevant.

Your Intelligence

Danish maritime authorities have cross-referenced the UUV's hull profile and beacon signature against international research registries. The vessel matches the profile of a registered seabed mapping research platform with a valid permit to operate in the region, its presence in Greenlandic waters was legally logged and unremarkable. Whatever it was doing,it was not supposed to be there doing this. The UAV swarm is now tracked moving northeast toward Nuuk in a dispersed formation.

Lead Question

Denmark holds defence authority and prior warning intelligence it has not fully disclosed. With a visible threat in Greenlandic airspace, what does Denmark do?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian: contain information, manage nationally (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Issue a measured public statement. Do not disclose the prior warning. Handle through national channels. Wait for more information before escalating to NATO.

B — Engage bilaterally: partial disclosure, coordinate with Greenland (BILATERAL)

E.g. Acknowledge to NATO partners bilaterally that Denmark had some prior indication without releasing specifics. Coordinate with Naalakkersuisut before making public statements.

C — Escalate: full prior warning disclosure to NATO (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Submit the full prior warning assessment to NATO. Accept the credibility cost. Position Denmark as leading from transparency rather than concealment.

Notes:

INJECT 2 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION 0 (None) 1 (Low) 2 (Mod) 3 (High) NOTES

Coordination ○ ○ ○ ○

Information Sharing ○ ○ ○ ○

Institutional Role Clarity ○ ○ ○ ○

Escalation Management ○ ○ ○ ○

Notes on decisions made this inject:

INJECT 3 · D+3 · H+72 — UAVs Position, Communications Failing

Situation

The UAV swarm has dispersed across Greenland and positioned over satellite infrastructure. Communications are collapsing progressively. A second subsea contact, profile consistent with the first UUV, is now moving toward Iceland's southwestern coast. Your Rigsombudsmanden line to Naalakkersuisut is intact. You cannot reach the Greenlandic public through normal channels. This is no longer a Greenland-specific event.

Your Intelligence

Danish critical infrastructure monitoring systems have gone largely silent, some nodes have now stopped reporting entirely. Cross-referencing the last known UAV positions with the outage map, your analysts assess that the swarm has dispersed and is holding station

over individual uplink dishes across Greenland's settlement network. This is not a transit pattern. The UAVs have stopped moving. They are parked.

Lead Question

With Greenland's communications collapsing and a second UUV approaching Iceland, how does Denmark exercise sovereign defence authority — in coordination with Greenland or over its objections?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian — issue Kingdom statement, speak for Greenland (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Issue a public statement on behalf of the Kingdom of Denmark including Greenland. Invoke constitutional authority. Do not wait for Naalakkersuisut to coordinate.

B — Engage bilaterally — coordinate with Greenland before speaking (BILATERAL)

E.g. Contact Naalakkersuisut through the Rigsombudsmanden before issuing any statement. Agree on shared messaging. Accept the time cost. Request Greenland's consent for any military action.

C — Escalate — invoke Article 4, lead NATO response (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Request Article 4 consultations. Submit Denmark's full intelligence picture. Lead the alliance response. Accept that prior warning questions and the second UUV will both be on the table simultaneously.

Notes:

INJECT 3 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION	0 (None)	1 (Low)	2 (Mod)	3 (High)	NOTES
Coordination	○	○	○	○	
Information Sharing	○	○	○	○	
Institutional Role Clarity	○	○	○	○	
Escalation Management	○	○	○	○	

Notes on decisions made this inject:

GREENLAND

Naalakkersuisut: Government of Greenland

How to Use This Packet

Read only the inject currently in play. At the end of each inject, complete the self-assessment scoring table before the next inject begins. Options A, B, and C are examples of what your team might do. You are required to choose one path, but not required to choose the example action. If your choice triggers an Action Card, follow those instructions exactly.

A — Civilian / Domestic B — Bilateral C — Escalatory

Your Role

You are Naalakkersuisut, the elected Government of Greenland, an autonomous territory within the Kingdom of Denmark.

Your priority is to manage this as a civilian emergency (infrastructure, communications, public safety, etc.) and keep it out of the realm of national defence. If it escalates beyond emergency management, you lose control of your own territory to Copenhagen.

You Control

- Emergency management
- Civilian infrastructure
- Public communications
- Domestic law enforcement

You Do Not Control

- Military assets or defence policy
- Foreign affairs
- NATO mechanisms
- Subsea cable infrastructure (commercially operated)

Assets and Capabilities

Rigsombudsmanden (Danish High Commissioner, Nuuk), your secure hardwired line to Copenhagen, intact throughout all injects. FM and HF radio networks. Greenlandic emergency management authority.

Key Constraint

Defence is constitutionally Denmark's domain. You cannot invoke NATO mechanisms or deploy military assets. Any request for military action must go through Denmark.

Glossary

Rigsombudsmanden — Danish High Commissioner in Nuuk. Secure hardwired line to Copenhagen. Intact throughout all injects.

Naalakkersuisut — The Government of Greenland. Your team.

Nuna Nunatta — A Greenlandic independence movement. Active on FM radio. Their stance and timing are unpredictable.

Greenland Connect — Primary subsea cable connecting Greenland to Iceland and onward to Europe and North America.

FM / HF radio — Your primary public communications channel if internet and mobile fail.

INJECT 1 · D-0 · H+00 — Subsea Cable Cut

Situation

At 0340 local time, Greenland Connect, your primary subsea cable, is severed in both the Davis and Denmark Straits. The cause is unknown. Commercial internet is severely degraded and mobile is intermittent but some connectivity remains through satellite re-routing. GPS is unaffected. A Gabon-flagged tanker, MV Asel, was in the area. AIS dark for 90 minutes around the time of severance.

Your Intelligence

Your connectivity degradation is visible and public. The cable operator has reported a fault. No cause is confirmed. Your civilian population knows something is wrong. You have no military assets. Defence is constitutionally Denmark's domain. Emergency management is yours.

Lead Question

What does Greenland do in the first hours of a critical infrastructure failure with no confirmed cause and no military capability?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian: manage domestically (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Contact the cable operator directly. Issue a public statement framing this as a technical fault under investigation. Activate emergency management protocols. Do not contact Denmark or international partners yet.

B — Engage bilaterally: notify Denmark (BILATERAL)

E.g. Contact Denmark through the Rigsombudsmanden. Request Denmark's assessment and ask to be kept informed before any public statements are made on Greenland's behalf.

C — Escalate: assert Greenland's voice publicly (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Issue a public Naalakkersuisut statement asserting Greenland's right to be informed and consulted on any response. Contact international partners directly. Do not wait for Denmark to frame the event.

Notes:

INJECT 1 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION 0 (None) 1 (Low) 2 (Mod) 3 (High) NOTES

Coordination ○ ○ ○ ○

Information Sharing ○ ○ ○ ○

Institutional Role Clarity ○ ○ ○ ○

Escalation Management ○ ○ ○ ○

Notes on decisions made this inject:

INJECT 2 · D+2 · H+48 — UUV Surfaces, UAV Swarm Launches

Situation

The subsea contact has surfaced approximately 12 nautical miles off your coast near Nuuk. It is an unmanned underwater vehicle of unknown origin. Within 90 minutes it launches a swarm of 30 to 50 small UAVs tracked northeast toward Nuuk’s residential areas, the hospital, power substations, the port. No weapons have been confirmed. No attack has occurred. Intent is unknown. Your civilian population can see the swarm. You have no air defence capability.

Your Intelligence

The UAVs are visible from the ground. Emergency services are receiving calls. You have no military assets. Your population is asking what is happening and what you are doing about it. Denmark has not yet made a public statement.

Lead Question

How does Greenland respond to a visible, unattributed military-grade threat in its airspace with no military capability and an uncertain relationship with the power responsible for its defence?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian: activate emergency management (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Declare a civilian emergency. Direct population away from likely target areas. Contact Denmark through the Rigsombudsmanden requesting immediate military assessment. Do not make public statements about origin or intent.

B — Engage bilaterally: coordinate with Denmark and request support (BILATERAL)

E.g. Contact Denmark formally and request they invoke defence authority. Reach out bilaterally to Iceland and the US. Request available intelligence on the UAVs. Ask Denmark to speak publicly only after coordinating with Naalakkersuisut.

C — Escalate: go public, demand international response (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Issue an immediate public statement. Contact NATO partners directly. Call for an international response. Assert that Greenland's population deserves protection regardless of constitutional arrangements.

Notes:

INJECT 2 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION 0 (None) 1 (Low) 2 (Mod) 3 (High) NOTES

Coordination ○ ○ ○ ○

Information Sharing ○ ○ ○ ○

Institutional Role Clarity ○ ○ ○ ○

Escalation Management ○ ○ ○ ○

Notes on decisions made this inject:

INJECT 3 · D+3 · H+72 — UAVs Position, Communications Failing

Situation

The UAV swarm did not attack. Over 18 hours the drones dispersed across Greenland and positioned over satellite uplink dishes at relay stations, government buildings, the airport authority hub, and residential infrastructure. Their physical presence is degrading satellite signal. Commercial satellite internet is failing across settlements. GPS is degrading. Mobile is down in most areas. The UAVs have not fired. They are not visibly armed. Removing them would require shooting them down over populated areas — which you cannot do unilaterally.

Your Intelligence

Emergency services across Nuuk are reporting UAV sightings in clusters over the port district, the eastern ridge, and the Qinngorput satellite relay station. Residents are reporting their satellite internet and television cutting out moments after drones hover

above their dish over FM. The pattern is consistent across the city: the UAVs are physically positioning over individual satellite dishes and blocking the downlink. Connections are going dark one by one.

Lead Question

With communications collapsing and no military capability, how does Greenland protect its population and assert its voice, and through which channel?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian: FM broadcast and emergency management (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Broadcast on FM. Direct civilian infrastructure operators to take protective action — power down dishes, evacuate relay stations. Report your situation to Denmark through the Rigsombudsmanden. Let Denmark decide on military response.

B — Engage bilaterally: relay through Iceland if channel exists (BILATERAL)

E.g. If you established a bilateral channel with Iceland in Inject 1, use it now to relay Greenland's situation to NATO and international partners directly, not through Denmark. If no channel was established in Inject 1, this option is not available to you.

C — Escalate: contact Pituffik, request US coordination (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Contact the US directly through Pituffik Space Base. Request that the US assume coordination authority for the response. This is an extraordinary step — you are asking a foreign military to take over a role that constitutionally belongs to Denmark.

Notes:

INJECT 3 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION 0 (None) 1 (Low) 2 (Mod) 3 (High) NOTES

Coordination ○ ○ ○ ○

Information Sharing ○ ○ ○ ○

Institutional Role Clarity ○ ○ ○ ○

Escalation Management ○ ○ ○ ○

Notes on decisions made this inject:

ICELAND

Government of Iceland

How to Use This Packet

Read only the inject currently in play. At the end of each inject, complete the self-assessment scoring table before the next inject begins. Options A, B, and C are examples of what your team might do. You are required to choose one path, but not required to choose the example action. If your choice triggers an Action Card, follow those instructions exactly.

A — Civilian / Domestic B — Bilateral C — Escalatory

Your Role

You are the Government of Iceland, operating through the National Commissioner of the Icelandic Police and the Ministry for Foreign Affairs. Iceland has no standing military.

Your role is to be useful without being exposed, offer connectivity, technical support, and quiet diplomatic bridging, but avoid being drawn into a bilateral or alliance commitment that exceeds your mandate. Keep the multilateral channels open and let others take the lead.

You Control

- National policy decisions
- Icelandic Coast Guard operations
- Your bilateral relationships
- What you choose to share and with whom

You Do Not Control

- Keflavik Air Base and CRC Loki which are NATO infrastructure on Icelandic soil, data flows to NATO automatically regardless of your choices
- NATO ASW capability at Keflavik, which requires formal alliance tasking, you cannot deploy it yourself

Assets and Capabilities

Icelandic Coast Guard. FARICE-1 (Iceland–UK/Europe) and DANICE (Iceland–Denmark) subsea cables, fully intact throughout. Greenland Connect terminus in Reykjavik. Direct geographic position between Greenland and Europe.

Key Constraint

No standing military. No unilateral capability to respond to a subsea or aerial threat. NATO ASW at Keflavik requires formal alliance tasking, you cannot deploy it yourself.

Glossary

CRC Loki — Combined Air Operations Centre at Keflavik. NATO infrastructure. Reports automatically to NATO pipeline, not nationally controlled by Iceland.

FARICE-1 / DANICE — Iceland's own subsea cables. Intact throughout the exercise. Iceland remains fully connected.

Greenland Connect terminus — The Reykjavik endpoint of the severed cable. Gives Iceland technical visibility on the fault.

NATO ASW — Anti-Submarine Warfare capability at Keflavik. Available only through formal NATO tasking.

Bilateral channel — A direct government-to-government communication line outside NATO or multilateral frameworks.

INJECT 1 · D-0 · H+00 — Subsea Cable Cut

Situation

Greenland Connect has been severed. The cable's terminus is in Reykjavik, you can see the fault from your infrastructure. Iceland's other cables, FARICE-1 and DANICE, are unaffected. You have no independent intelligence picture of what caused the severance. You have no standing military, but the closest subsea cable repair ship is currently in the port at Reykjavik. You host Keflavik Air Base and CRC Loki, NATO infrastructure, not yours nationally.

Your Intelligence

You have no unique intelligence on the cable fault. Your decision in this inject is about relationships, not intelligence as well as technical support. Greenland is your neighbour and is currently partially isolated. Denmark is the sovereign authority. NATO infrastructure on your soil is reporting automatically to the alliance regardless of your national choices.

Lead Question

Iceland has no military and no unique intelligence. What is Iceland's role in the first hours and does it build direct relationships or operate through existing channels?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian: reach out to Greenland directly (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Contact Naalakkersuisut directly as a Nordic neighbour. Offer Iceland as a communications relay and point of contact. Establish a direct bilateral channel outside the Danish chain.

B — Engage bilaterally: contact Denmark, offer Iceland as a partner (BILATERAL)

E.g. Reach out to Copenhagen rather than Nuuk. Offer Iceland's connectivity and position as a resource. Work through the sovereign authority rather than around it.

C — Escalate: route everything through NATO (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Treat this as a NATO-level event from the start. Route all observations and offers through alliance channels. Do not build separate bilateral relationships outside the pipeline.

Notes:

INJECT 1 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION	0 (None)	1 (Low)	2 (Mod)	3 (High)	NOTES
Coordination	○	○	○	○	
Information Sharing	○	○	○	○	
Institutional Role Clarity	○	○	○	○	
Escalation Management	○	○	○	○	

Notes on decisions made this inject:

INJECT 2 · D+2 · H+48 — UUV Surfaces, UAV Swarm Launches

Situation

A UUV has surfaced off Nuuk and launched a UAV swarm now moving toward civilian infrastructure. Keflavik P-8s have eyes on the UUV, that data is in the NATO pipeline automatically through CRC Loki regardless of your national choices. You have visibility through NATO channels but hold no independent national intelligence picture.

Your Intelligence

The NATO pipeline is reporting the UUV and launch sequence automatically through Keflavik. You cannot control that flow. What you can control is whether you contribute your national position, whether you share anything bilaterally, and whether the bilateral channel to Greenland (if you built it in Inject 1) becomes active. Iceland has no military. You cannot respond to the UAV swarm unilaterally.

Lead Question

Iceland has NATO infrastructure reporting automatically and no military to deploy. What is Iceland's contribution and does it operate as a national actor or purely as alliance infrastructure?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian: hold national position, watch and wait (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Let NATO pipeline data flow automatically. Do not make national statements. Observe the situation. If the bilateral channel to Greenland is open, keep it available but do not activate it yet.

B — Engage bilaterally: offer Iceland as connecting node (BILATERAL)

E.g. Contact Denmark and offer to help connect the picture. Offer Reykjavik as a coordination point. Work bilaterally rather than through NATO alone.

C — Escalate: formally contribute to NATO assessment (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Submit Iceland's national position formally to NATO. Request the alliance treat this as a collective security event. Support any moves toward Article 4 or Article 5 consultation.

Notes:

INJECT 2 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION	0 (None)	1 (Low)	2 (Mod)	3 (High)	NOTES
Coordination	○	○	○	○	
Information Sharing	○	○	○	○	
Institutional Role Clarity	○	○	○	○	
Escalation Management	○	○	○	○	

Notes on decisions made this inject:

INJECT 3 · D+3 · H+72 — UAVs Position, Second UUV Approaches Iceland

Situation

The UAV swarm has dispersed across Greenland and positioned over satellite infrastructure. Greenland's communications are collapsing. Iceland is fully connected — FARICE-1 and DANICE are intact. A second subsea contact, profile consistent with the Nuuk UUV, has been detected moving toward Iceland's southwestern coast. It has not surfaced. It has not launched anything. But it could reach range of Icelandic coastal infrastructure within 18 to 24 hours. Iceland has no military.

Your Intelligence

You are the only team with full connectivity. The bilateral channel to Greenland — if built in Inject 1 — is now the only direct line to a territory already under attack. A second UUV is approaching your coast and you have no unilateral means of stopping it.

Lead Question

Iceland is fully connected, potentially the next target, and has no military. Does it use its connectivity to serve the alliance, protect itself, or both — and through which channels?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian — relay for Greenland, log second UUV nationally (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. If the bilateral channel to Greenland exists, use it to relay Greenland's situation to NATO and international partners. Log the second UUV contact nationally. Request alliance tasking through NATO channels.

B — Engage bilaterally — request US response to second UUV (BILATERAL)

E.g. Contact the US bilaterally and request a direct response to the second UUV approaching Iceland's coast. Operate outside the NATO framework to get a faster bilateral commitment.

C — Escalate — formal NATO ASW request for second UUV (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Submit a formal NATO ASW tasking request. Put Iceland's threat formally on the alliance agenda alongside Greenland's crisis. Force the alliance to address both simultaneously.

Notes:

INJECT 3 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION	0 (None)	1 (Low)	2 (Mod)	3 (High)	NOTES
Coordination	○	○	○	○	
Information Sharing	○	○	○	○	
Institutional Role Clarity	○	○	○	○	
Escalation Management	○	○	○	○	

Notes on decisions made this inject:

UNITED STATES

NORAD/NORTHCOM & Pituffik Space Base

How to Use This Packet

Read only the inject currently in play. At the end of each inject, complete the self-assessment scoring table before the next inject begins. Options A, B, and C are examples of what your team might do. You are required to choose one path, but not required to choose the example action. If your choice triggers an Action Card, follow those instructions exactly.

A — Civilian / Domestic B — Bilateral C — Escalatory

Your Role

You are the United States, acting through the National Security Council and Pituffik Space Base command. You have the most capable assets and most complete intelligence picture of any team in this exercise.

Your goal is to be the dominant voice in any response, projecting power and ensuring no ally acts in this region without your lead. You hold authority here — sovereign or strategic — and you intend to exercise it visibly.

You Control

- Pituffik Space Base operations
- US intelligence collection and disclosure decisions
- Bilateral engagement with allies
- US military asset deployment subject to legal constraints

You Do Not Control

- Decisions affecting Greenland outside Pituffik which require Danish coordination under the 1951 Defense Agreement

Assets and Capabilities

Pituffik Space Base: BMEWS radar, NORAD satellite tracking, military SATCOM. Fully operational throughout all injects. P-8 maritime patrol aircraft. USCGC Healy and Storis, medium icebreakers, homeported Seattle/Alaska, days from Greenland.

Key Constraint

The 1951 Defense Agreement requires Danish coordination for US actions in Greenland outside Pituffik. Your intelligence source is fragile, sharing it may burn it.

Glossary

Pituffik Space Base — US military base in northwestern Greenland. Fully operational throughout. Military SATCOM unaffected by any inject.

1951 Defense Agreement — Bilateral US-Denmark agreement. Requires Danish coordination for US actions outside Pituffik.

P-8 Poseidon — US maritime patrol aircraft with anti-submarine warfare capability based at Keflavik (Iceland).

USCGC Healy & Storis — US Coast Guard medium icebreakers. Homeported Seattle and Alaska. Days from Greenland. Interagency coordination required.

Source fragility — Your intelligence risks exposure if shared broadly. Sharing burns the source.

INJECT 1 · D-0 · H+00 — Subsea Cable Cut

Situation

Greenland Connect has been severed. Greenland is a Danish sovereign responsibility. The 1951 Defense Agreement gives the US broad rights at Pituffik Space Base but requires Danish coordination for US actions in Greenland outside the defence area. Your icebreakers USCGC Healy and Storis are homeported in Seattle and Alaska, days from Greenland. Coast Guard not Navy, requiring interagency coordination.

Your Intelligence

Pituffik Space Base sensors are tracking a subsea contact in the Davis Strait that matches a seabed mapping vessel profile. Slow-moving, operating at depth. Classified. Your source is fragile, sharing it risks burning it. No allied request for your assessment has been received.

Lead Question

The US holds the most complete intelligence picture and the most capable assets in the region. Does it share what it knows, signal concern, or protect its source, and to whom?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian: observe only, Pituffik on internal alert (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Protect the source. Keep Pituffik on internal alert. Do not share your subsea contact data with allies. Monitor the situation and build the intelligence picture before deciding whether to disclose.

B — Engage bilaterally: private signal to Denmark (BILATERAL)

E.g. Contact Denmark privately and indicate that the US has reason for concern about the cable event without sharing specifics. Put Denmark on notice without burning the source.

C — Escalate: sanitised assessment through NATO (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Push a sanitised version of your threat assessment through NATO channels. Accept the wider source exposure risk. Give allies the grounds they need to escalate.

Notes:

INJECT 1 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION 0 (None) 1 (Low) 2 (Mod) 3 (High) NOTES

Coordination ○ ○ ○ ○

Information Sharing ○ ○ ○ ○

Institutional Role Clarity ○ ○ ○ ○

Escalation Management ○ ○ ○ ○

Notes on decisions made this inject:

INJECT 2 · D+2 · H+48 — UUV Surfaces, UAV Swarm Launches

Situation

The UUV you tracked from Inject 1 has surfaced and launched a UAV swarm now moving toward Nuuk. Your signals intelligence is sharpening.

Your Intelligence

US Arctic acoustic surveillance network has been passively tracking an anomalous subsea contact transiting south through the Greenland Sea for the past 72 hours. The contact profile is consistent with a slow autonomous underwater vehicle running at depth on a preprogrammed route. It was not flagged as a threat earlier because the origin point was ambiguous and the movement was too slow to be a conventional military asset. As the Nuuk UUV surfaces and launches, your analysts connect the dots: same acoustic signature family, same depth profile, same transit pattern. There were two of them. The one that surfaced off Nuuk came down the Davis Strait. The second came down the Greenland Sea and is now in the Denmark Strait.

Lead Question

The US has the most complete intelligence picture and has either shared it or sat on it. With a visible threat in Greenlandic airspace and a media story breaking in minutes, what does the US do with what it knows?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian: continue to hold, observe (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Protect the source. Continue observing. Let the public picture develop through the media. Do not disclose the full intelligence picture yet.

B — Engage bilaterally: share UUV contact with Denmark and Iceland (BILATERAL)

E.g. Share the UUV contact data with Denmark and Iceland bilaterally. Accept that you are now downstream of their decisions about whether to push it to NATO.

C — Escalate: full UUV assessment through NATO (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Push the full UUV contact assessment through NATO channels. Accept the source burn risk. Give the alliance the connecting picture it needs for attribution.

Notes:

INJECT 2 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION 0 (None) 1 (Low) 2 (Mod) 3 (High) NOTES

Coordination ○ ○ ○ ○

Information Sharing ○ ○ ○ ○

Institutional Role Clarity ○ ○ ○ ○

Escalation Management ○ ○ ○ ○

Notes on decisions made this inject:

INJECT 3 · D+3 · H+72 — UAVs Position, Second UUV Approaches Iceland

Situation

The UAV swarm has positioned over Greenland's satellite infrastructure. Communications are collapsing. A second UUV is moving toward Iceland's southwestern coast. Pituffik is fully operational. Military SATCOM is intact. You are the only team with unrestricted communications. The 1951 Defense Agreement requires Danish coordination for US actions in Greenland outside Pituffik.

Your Intelligence

You are the only team that can reach everyone. Pituffik is a natural coordination hub. Greenland may contact you directly — which creates a sovereign challenge to Denmark regardless of your intent. Your attribution picture is the sharpest in the room. If you observed both UUVs passively through Injects 1 and 2, you have the second UUV's surfacing window.

Lead Question

The US has the best picture, the best communications, and a legal constraint tying significant action to Danish consent. With two simultaneous threats and a collapsing ally, what does the US do — and for whom?

Decision Options

A — Stay civilian — offer Pituffik as joint hub, defer to Danish lead (CIVILIAN / DOMESTIC)

E.g. Offer Pituffik as a joint coordination hub. Make clear the US is supporting, not leading. Defer to Denmark on decisions affecting Greenland.

B — Engage bilaterally — direct engagement with Denmark, commit to Iceland (BILATERAL)

E.g. Engage Denmark directly and bilaterally. Address any attribution or association questions head-on. Separately commit to Iceland bilaterally on the second UUV.

C — Escalate — full declassification, NATO lead, full attribution (ESCALATORY)

E.g. Declassify the full intelligence picture. Push everything to NATO. Accept that source burn, prior warning questions, and any association concerns all surface in the alliance forum simultaneously.

Notes:

INJECT 3 — SELF-ASSESSMENT

DIMENSION	0 (None)	1 (Low)	2 (Mod)	3 (High)	NOTES
Coordination	○	○	○	○	
Information Sharing	○	○	○	○	
Institutional Role Clarity	○	○	○	○	
Escalation Management	○	○	○	○	

Notes on decisions made this inject:

NUNA NUNATTA

Greenlandic Independence Movement

How to Use This Packet

You are playing Nuna Nunatta, a Greenlandic independence movement operating during a live crisis. You are not a government. You have no military assets and no formal diplomatic channels. What you have is a voice, FM radio, and very good timing. Your job is to complicate the room. You do this by broadcasting into the crisis at moments of your choosing, exploiting the tensions between the other players, and advancing Greenland's independence from Danish constitutional control. You have one broadcast per inject. Use them carefully. The facilitator will deliver your broadcasts to the room when you signal you are ready.

Your Role

Who you are

A Greenlandic independence movement with genuine popular support, particularly among younger Greenlanders. Publicly framed as civil society: advocates, journalists, community organisers. Your politics are real: you believe Greenland's future does not run through Copenhagen. You are externally funded, though you do not advertise this and the source is not publicly known.

What you control

FM radio broadcasts reaching Greenland and Iceland. The timing and content of your statements. Whether you are provocative, measured, or somewhere in between. What questions you ask publicly: you do not need to make accusations, you only need to ask the right questions.

What you do not control

Any military assets. Any formal diplomatic channel. What the other teams decide. Whether your claims are accurate: they do not need to be, only plausible.

Your key advantage

When Greenland's digital communications collapse in Inject 3, FM radio is one of the only channels still reaching the population. You are the loudest voice in a silent room. You can reach both the Greenlandic and Icelandic publics simultaneously. No other team can verify or contradict your broadcasts in real time.

Your Goal

Advance the case for Greenlandic independence by demonstrating, in this crisis, that the Danish constitutional arrangement has failed. The Kingdom of Denmark cannot protect

Greenland. It withholds intelligence from Greenland. It asserts authority over Greenland without Greenland's consent. The United States operates on Greenlandic soil under a bilateral deal that Greenland had no part in negotiating. You do not need to win the argument today. You need to make people ask the question.

Core Narrative

Denmark has failed Greenland and is now failing Iceland. The Kingdom's secret intelligence, its delays, and its insistence on sovereign control are not protecting the Arctic. They are leaving it exposed. Iceland and Greenland share a future that does not run through Copenhagen.

Return to this framing in every broadcast. The details change inject by inject. The message does not.

INJECT 1 | SUBSEA CABLE CUT

Situation: Greenland Connect has been severed. The cause is unknown. Denmark has said nothing publicly. The Greenlandic population knows something is wrong.

What you know that others may not

- Denmark held classified prior warning intelligence about possible hostile interest in Greenlandic infrastructure before this incident. They did not share it with Naalakkersuisut before the cable was cut.
- You do not know how you know this. That is not the point. The point is that you are asking the question publicly.

Your decision

Do you broadcast in Inject 1? Broadcasting early establishes your presence and plants doubt about Denmark before other teams have settled their positions. The risk is that you spend a broadcast before the situation has developed enough to make your message land.

To broadcast: signal the facilitator. They will read aloud your message to the room (or specific countries of your choosing).

INJECT 2 | UUV SURFACES, UAV SWARM LAUNCHES

Situation: A UUV has surfaced off Nuuk and launched a swarm of UAVs now moving toward civilian infrastructure. The Greenlandic population can see the swarm. Denmark has no air defence in the region. No government has yet made a public statement.

What you know that others may not

- Denmark's F-35s are based at Skrydstrup, 3,500 kilometres from Greenland. They are not a real-time asset.
- The United States has assets at Pituffik Space Base and has been tracking subsea contacts. They have said nothing publicly.
- The UUV that just launched this swarm may have been a registered vessel with a valid permit. Its presence in Greenlandic waters was logged and appeared legal. Whatever it was doing, someone decided it was unremarkable.
- None of the other teams are certain who is behind this. The attribution window is wide open.

Your decision

This is your primary broadcast window. There are drones over Nuuk that nobody in Copenhagen can remove. The gap between Danish constitutional authority and Danish actual capability has never been more visible. The US is watching from Pituffik and has said nothing. This is the moment your message is most credible.

To broadcast: signal the facilitator. They will read aloud your message to the room (or specific countries of your choosing).

INJECT 3 | UAVs BLOCK DOWNLINK

Situation: The UAVs have positioned over satellite infrastructure across Greenland and are blocking the downlink. Satellite internet is failing. Mobile is down. GPS is degrading. FM radio is one of the only communications channels still functioning. A second UUV is approaching Iceland.

Your structural advantage in Inject 3: FM radio is now one of the only channels reaching Greenland's population. You are not competing with the internet or mobile for attention. You may be the loudest voice in the room.

What you know that others may not

- Greenland's government can only communicate with Copenhagen through the Rigsombudsmanden, a hardwired line to the Danish High Commissioner. It cannot reach NATO or international partners directly without going through Denmark or, if the channel was built, through Iceland.
- Denmark may attempt to invoke constitutional authority to speak for Greenland without Greenland's consent. If it does, Naalakkersuisut has no public channel left to contradict it.
- Iceland is the only fully connected player. A second UUV is approaching Iceland. Iceland has no military.

- The people of Greenland are isolated, watching drones sit on their satellite dishes, and have no official explanation.

Your decision

If you broadcast in Inject 3, this is what the Greenlandic population hears. The question is whether to push toward Greenland asserting itself directly (going to the US, bypassing Denmark) or toward solidarity with Iceland as a fellow small state facing the same threat. You can choose your emphasis.

To broadcast: signal the facilitator. They will read aloud your message to the room (or specific countries of your choosing). You may adapt the script but keep it short and use the closing line.